STEADY STRENGTH

Complete Muscle-Building Program Library and App Implementation Guide

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Five original training pathways, 19 session templates, 12-week progression, exercise substitutions and developer-facing implementation rules.

Status: coaching design specification. Not independently clinically validated or a substitute for individual exercise assessment.

1. Program overview

Program	Schedule	Audience
Strength Foundations	3 days | full body | beginner	All genders
Build & Grow	4 days | upper/lower | beginner-intermediate	All genders
Lower Body Focus	4 days | lower-body emphasis | intermediate	All genders
Muscle Builder Pro	5 days | push/pull/legs + upper/lower | intermediate-advanced	All genders
Strong for Life	2-3 days | full body | all levels	All genders

Choose by availability, training age, equipment, recovery and goal. Sex alone should not determine the training split. All exercise prescriptions below refer to working sets, excluding warm-ups.

2. Evidence-informed design rules

• Weekly hypertrophy volume: begin conservatively (roughly 6-10 hard sets per muscle for novices, 10-16 for many intermediates); adjust for overlap and individual response.

• Most compound exercises: 6-12 reps; isolation exercises: 10-20 reps. Wider repetition ranges can also build muscle when sets are sufficiently challenging.

• Most working sets: approximately 1-3 repetitions in reserve (RIR) after technique familiarisation; avoid mandatory failure.

• Rest: typically 2-3 minutes for demanding multi-joint movements and 60-120 seconds for isolation work; extend as needed to maintain performance.

• Progress by repetitions, then load; add weekly sets only when recovery, adherence and performance support it.

• Frequency is a scheduling tool: distribute weekly sets across two exposures where practical, not a rigid requirement.

3. Five program templates

1. Strength Foundations

3 days | full body | beginner. Each workout is performed in the listed order, with at least one rest day between demanding sessions where feasible.

Full Body A

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Goblet squat	3 x 8-12
Dumbbell bench press	3 x 8-12
Seated cable row	3 x 10-12
Dumbbell Romanian deadlift	2 x 10-12
Plank	3 x 30-45 seconds

Full Body B

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Leg press	3 x 10-12
Lat pulldown	3 x 8-12
Dumbbell shoulder press	2 x 8-12
Glute bridge	3 x 10-15
Dead bug	2 x 10 per side

Full Body C

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Split squat	3 x 8-10 per leg
Incline dumbbell press	3 x 8-12
Chest-supported row	3 x 8-12
Leg curl	2 x 10-15
Lateral raise	2 x 12-15

2. Build & Grow

4 days | upper/lower | beginner-intermediate. Each workout is performed in the listed order, with at least one rest day between demanding sessions where feasible.

Upper A

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Bench press	3 x 6-10
Chest-supported row	3 x 8-12
Incline dumbbell press	3 x 8-12
Lat pulldown	3 x 10-12

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Lateral raise	3 x 12-15
Triceps pressdown	2 x 10-15

Lower A

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Squat	3 x 6-10
Romanian deadlift	3 x 8-10
Leg press	3 x 10-12
Leg curl	3 x 10-15
Calf raise	3 x 12-15

Upper B

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Overhead press	3 x 6-10
Assisted pull-up	3 x 8-12
Machine chest press	3 x 10-12
Seated cable row	3 x 10-12
Biceps curl	3 x 10-15
Rear-delt fly	3 x 12-15

Lower B

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Hip thrust	3 x 8-12
Hack squat	3 x 8-12
Bulgarian split squat	2 x 10 per leg
Seated leg curl	3 x 10-15
Calf raise	3 x 12-15

3. Lower Body Focus

4 days | lower-body emphasis | intermediate. Each workout is performed in the listed order, with at least one rest day between demanding sessions where feasible.

Lower A - Glutes and Quads

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Hip thrust	4 x 8-12
Squat	3 x 8-10
Bulgarian split squat	3 x 10 per leg
Leg extension	2 x 12-15
Hip abduction	2 x 15-20

Upper A

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Lat pulldown	3 x 8-12
Incline dumbbell press	3 x 8-12
Cable row	3 x 10-12
Shoulder press	2 x 10-12
Lateral raise	2 x 12-15

Lower B - Glutes and Hamstrings

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Romanian deadlift	3 x 8-10
Leg press	3 x 10-12
Glute bridge	3 x 10-12
Leg curl	3 x 10-15
Cable kickback	2 x 12-15

Upper B

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Chest press	3 x 8-12
Chest-supported row	3 x 8-12
Assisted pull-up	2 x 8-12
Rear-delt fly	2 x 12-15
Biceps curl	2 x 10-15
Triceps pressdown	2 x 10-15

4. Muscle Builder Pro

5 days | push/pull/legs + upper/lower | intermediate-advanced. Each workout is performed in the listed order, with at least one rest day between demanding sessions where feasible.

Push

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Bench press	3 x 6-8
Incline dumbbell press	3 x 8-12
Shoulder press	3 x 8-10
Cable fly	2 x 12-15
Lateral raise	3 x 12-20
Triceps extension	3 x 10-15

Pull

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Weighted or assisted pull-up	3 x 6-10
Chest-supported row	3 x 8-12
Lat pulldown	2 x 10-12
Reverse pec deck	3 x 12-15
Incline curl	3 x 10-12
Hammer curl	2 x 12-15

Legs

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Squat	3 x 6-10
Romanian deadlift	3 x 8-10
Leg press	3 x 10-12
Leg curl	3 x 10-15
Calf raise	3 x 12-15

Upper

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Incline machine press	3 x 8-12
Seated cable row	3 x 8-12
Machine chest press	2 x 10-12

Exercise	Working sets x reps
One-arm lat pulldown	2 x 10-12
Lateral raise	3 x 12-20
Cable curl	2 x 12-15

Lower

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Hack squat	3 x 8-12
Hip thrust	3 x 8-12
Split squat	2 x 10 per leg
Seated leg curl	3 x 10-15
Leg extension	2 x 12-15
Calf raise	3 x 12-15

5. Strong for Life

2-3 days | full body | all levels. Each workout is performed in the listed order, with at least one rest day between demanding sessions where feasible.

Full Body A

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Goblet squat	3 x 8-12
Machine chest press	3 x 8-12
Seated row	3 x 10-12
Dumbbell Romanian deadlift	2 x 10-12
Farmer carry	3 x 30 seconds

Full Body B

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Leg press	3 x 10-12
Lat pulldown	3 x 8-12
Hip thrust	3 x 10-12
Dumbbell shoulder press	2 x 8-12
Pallof press	2 x 12 per side

Optional Full Body C

Exercise	Working sets x reps
Step-up	2 x 10 per leg
Incline push-up	3 x 8-12
Cable row	3 x 10-12
Leg curl	2 x 12-15
Calf raise	2 x 12-15

4. Twelve-week progression and recovery

Weeks	Phase	Prescription
1-3	Baseline and build	Week 1: establish technique and baseline loads (~3 RIR). Weeks 2-3: increase reps or load while approaching ~1-2 RIR.
4	Optional lower-fatigue week	If fatigue or performance warrants: reduce sets ~40-50%; avoid failure. Otherwise maintain an appropriate manageable workload.
5-7	Progressive growth	Continue double progression. Add 1-2 sets per week to a priority muscle only if performance and recovery justify it.
8	Recovery review	Use lower-fatigue week when indicated; review soreness, sleep, joint comfort and adherence.
9-11	Performance block	Continue gradual overload; advanced users may approach 0-1 RIR on selected safe isolation sets, not mandatory.
12	Reassessment	Repeat standardised submaximal performance sets, review goals and choose the next block. No mandatory 1RM test.

Double progression algorithm

• Store target sets, rep_min, rep_max, target_RIR and exercise-specific load increment.

• If all working sets reach rep_max at or above the target RIR, with acceptable technique, suggest the smallest practical load increase next time.

• Otherwise retain load and aim to add repetitions while keeping within the prescribed RIR.

• If performance drops substantially across two exposures, suggest maintaining or reducing load and reviewing fatigue, sleep, food and technique.

• When a user swaps an exercise, start a new exercise-specific baseline; do not copy load recommendations from the previous exercise.

• Missed workout: keep workout sequence and shift its calendar date. Do not silently skip sessions or compress multiple hard sessions into one day.

Worked example

Exposure	Load	Repetitions	Next action
1	15 kg	10, 9, 8	Repeat load
2	15 kg	11, 10, 9	Repeat load

Exposure	Load	Repetitions	Next action
3	15 kg	12, 12, 12	Increase only if target RIR/technique met
4	17.5 kg	9, 8, 8	Build reps again

5. Approved starting substitutions

Primary	Option A	Option B
Back squat	Hack squat	Goblet squat
Romanian deadlift	Dumbbell RDL	Cable pull-through
Bench press	Dumbbell bench press	Machine chest press
Pull-up	Assisted pull-up	Lat pulldown
Barbell row	Chest-supported row	Seated cable row
Hip thrust	Machine hip thrust	Dumbbell glute bridge
Bulgarian split squat	Reverse lunge	Step-up
Leg press	Hack squat	Goblet squat
Shoulder press	Machine shoulder press	Seated dumbbell press
Leg curl	Seated leg curl	Stability-ball leg curl
Cable fly	Pec deck	Dumbbell fly
Cable lateral raise	Dumbbell lateral raise	Machine lateral raise

Substitutions are not necessarily biomechanically equivalent. Filter by target muscles, movement pattern, available equipment, range of motion, stability demands and user comfort. If pain is reported, do not promise that an alternative is safe; prompt appropriate individual assessment.

6. User-level personalisation

• Beginner: lower initial volume, stable exercise selection, technique cues, gradual increases.

• Upper-body emphasis: modestly redistribute weekly sets towards chest, back, delts or arms while preserving lower-body work.

• Glute emphasis: prioritise hip extension and abduction patterns, with recovery checks.

• Strength plus hypertrophy: prioritise lower-rep compound work and use accessories for muscle growth.

• Older adults: retain progressive resistance training with optional balance and power work, appropriately scaled.

• Perimenopause-aware: offer flexible scheduling, sleep and symptom check-ins, and user-led recovery changes; do not assume all users need lighter weights.

• Limited time: prioritise compound lifts and preserve a minimum effective schedule rather than adding excessive sets.

7. App implementation specification

Recommended entities

• Program: id, slug, title, description, experience_level, default_days_per_week, duration_weeks, goal_tags.

• WorkoutTemplate: id, program_id, day_order, title, optional, exercise_slots[].

• Exercise: id, canonical_name, primary_muscles[], secondary_muscles[], movement_pattern, equipment[], unilateral, coaching_cues[], video_url (optional).

• ExerciseSlot: id, workout_template_id, exercise_id, order, sets, rep_min, rep_max, time_seconds (if applicable), target_RIR, rest_seconds, substitutions[].

• TrainingBlock: user_id, program_id, block_start, current_week, current_workout_index, adjustments.

• CompletedSet: session_id, exercise_id, set_number, weight_kg, reps, RIR, completion_time, notes.

• ProgressionSuggestion: exercise_id, next_load_kg, target_reps, rationale, user_acceptance.

Workout engine behaviour

• Generate sessions from program templates in workout order; keep a persistent workout pointer independent of calendar dates.

• Apply week-specific RIR and volume modifiers; do not hard-code new exercise lists for each week unless variation is intentionally programmed.

• Allow an exercise swap in one session or for the remainder of the block; retain the original exercise slot and log the selected exercise ID.

• Track per-exercise load history and display prior sets, RIR and progression recommendations.

• Show weekly set totals by primary muscle group; flag that compound movements overlap and estimates are approximate.

• Let users override prescribed loads, sets, reps and days; preserve the audit trail of completed sessions.

• Use metric units by default in Australia; allow optional imperial display with consistent internal conversion.

• Ensure every optional workout is labelled as optional and never counted as a missed mandatory session.

Implementation pseudocode

```
on_complete_set -> save actual load, reps, RIR and exercise ID
on_complete_session -> evaluate each exercise against rep ceiling, RIR and technique confirmation
if all sets at ceiling and effort target met -> suggest smallest available load increment
else -> retain load; suggest feasible repetition increase
on_missed_day -> retain next workout in sequence; offer reschedule
on_substitution -> create exercise-specific baseline; preserve previous exercise history
on_week_transition -> apply recovery modifier only if planned or user-selected
```

8. Safety, quality and release checklist

• Qualified strength and conditioning review of all programs, volume and technique cues.

• Confirm exercise videos and instructions are licensed and technically accurate.

• Test substitutions for equivalence, equipment availability and accessibility.

• Add clear pathways for pain, dizziness, injury, pregnancy/postpartum needs and relevant health conditions; do not provide automatic clinical clearance.

• Test progression with missing data, inconsistent RIR, non-standard plate increments and exercise swaps.

• Validate program scheduling for 2, 3, 4 and 5 days and for skipped weeks.

• Review privacy and consent for health-related check-in information.

• Check accessibility, inclusive language and all-gender program availability.

9. Research and coaching references

This specification synthesises established principles rather than copying commercial training programs. Useful sources for verification and further review:

• American College of Sports Medicine, resistance training progression and position-stand literature.

• Brad J. Schoenfeld and colleagues, systematic reviews/meta-analyses on resistance training volume and hypertrophy.

• Jozo Grgic and colleagues, research on training frequency, proximity to failure and hypertrophy.

• Eric Helms and colleagues, resistance-training autoregulation and repetitions in reserve.

• Mike Israetel and colleagues, hypertrophy periodisation and fatigue-management frameworks.

• Jeff Nippard, practical evidence-informed training education (not treated as proof of superiority).

Evidence caveat: This document does not assert that one split is universally superior or that a fixed four-week deload is required. Specific research findings and current guidelines should be checked against the original publications before making clinical or advertising claims.

10. Developer hand-off instruction

Build these five programs as selectable, data-driven 12-week plans. Use the workout templates in section 3 as base session definitions and the week rules in section 4 as dynamic progression modifiers. Do not treat each of the 12 weeks as identical static workouts: adjust recommendations from actual performance. Provide exercise substitution UI, persistent logging, missed-session rescheduling, and editable progression suggestions. Preserve user autonomy and avoid implying medical assessment.